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PET PROVISIONING SYSTEM

Abstract

In some implementations, a pet provisioning system includes a dish, a pedestal and a mat. The dish may have a cylindrical wall, a central axis, a bottom, a top opening whose perimeter lies on an oblique plane that intersects the central axis at an angle other than normal to the central axis, and a ridge that extends below the bottom. The mat may have a top surface and a bottom surface that define a thickness. The mat may be made of diatomaceous earth and may include a mat recess extending from the top surface into the thickness. The pedestal may have a bottom end, a top end, a height, and a pedestal recess at the top end The bottom end may have a shape and size that corresponds to the mat recess. The pedestal recess may have a shape and size that corresponds to the ridge.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS [0001] This application claims priority to U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 63/560,691, filed Mar. 2, 2024, titled “Pet Provisioning System” and incorporates the same herein by reference.

TECHNICAL FIELD

[0002] Various implementations relate generally to pet provisioning systems and may include food and water dishes, mats and supports therefor.

BACKGROUND

[0003] Pets require regular provisioning of food and water. Many pet owners provide water dishes in locations and at heights that enable their pets to regularly hydrate themselves. Pet owners may also provide separate food dishes with food for their pets-often proximate to their water dishes. In some cases, the food dishes may be provided only at specific mealtimes; in other cases (e.g., for pets that are able to regulate their own food consumption), food dishes may be available throughout the day.

[0004] Some pets may be messy when eating or drinking. Accordingly, mats may be provided with food and water dishes to contain spills and to protect floors and other surfaces near the food and water dishes. Some mats may require regular cleaning and drying to avoid the growth of mildew or to avoid attracting insects, rodents or other pests.

SUMMARY

[0005] In some implementations, a pet provisioning system includes a dish, a pedestal and a mat.

[0006] The dish may have a cylindrical wall, a central axis, a planar bottom perpendicular to the central axis, a top opening whose perimeter lies on an oblique plane that intersects the central axis at an angle other than normal to the central axis, and a ridge that extends below the planar bottom on an opposite side of an interior space defined by the planar bottom and the cylindrical wall.

[0007] The mat may have a top surface and a bottom surface, and the top surface and the bottom surface may define a thickness. The dish may be made of a material that resists absorption of liquid. For example, the dish may be made of a ceramic. The mat may be made of diatomaceous earth. The mat may include a mat recess extending from the top surface into the thickness. In some implementations, the top surface of the mat may be shaped as a closed composite figure that is void of sharp angles. In other implementation, the mat may be generally rectangular in shape, with rounded corners and a chamfered edge along a perimeter of its top surface.

[0008] The pedestal may have a bottom end, a top end, a height, and a pedestal recess at the top end. The bottom end may have a shape and size that corresponds to the mat recess-such that the bottom end can be disposed into the mat recess; and when the bottom end is disposed in the mat recess, the mat recess and bottom end cooperate to substantially resist translation of the pedestal relative to the mat. The pedestal recess may have a shape and size that corresponds to the ridge such that the ridge can be disposed into the pedestal recess; and when the ridge is disposed in the pedestal recess, the pedestal recess and the ridge cooperate to substantially resist translation of the dish relative to the pedestal. The pedestal may be made of a silicone having a Shore A durometer of about 50.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0009] FIG. **1** is a perspective view of an exemplary pet provisioning system having a mat, a pedestal and a dish

[0010] FIGS. **2**A and **2**B illustrate details of an exemplary dish.

[0011] FIG. **3** is an exploded view of the exemplary system shown in FIG. **1**.

[0012] FIG. **4** illustrates details of an exemplary pedestal.

[0013] FIG. **5** is a left-side view of an exemplary system;

[0014] FIG. **6** is a right-side view thereof;

[0015] FIG. **7** is a front view thereof;

[0016] FIG. **8** is a back view thereof;

[0017] FIG. **9** is a top view thereof; and

[0018] FIG. **10** is a bottom view thereof.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0019] FIG. **1** illustrates an exemplary pet provisioning system **101**. The exemplary system **101** may be employed as a food or water dish for small pets, such as, for example, dogs or cats. As shown, the system **101** may include a dish **104**, a pedestal **107** and a mat **110**.

[0020] In some implementations, the dish **104** has a generally cylindrical shape defined by a cylindrical wall **113** and characterized by a central axis **116**. In some implementations, the dish **104** has a planar bottom **119** (e.g., a bottom **119** that is perpendicular to the central axis **116**). In other implementations, the dish **104** may have a bottom **119** with a different shape (e.g., a bowl shape, or some other non-planar shape). The cylindrical wall **113** and bottom **119** define an interior space **122** that may be configured to hold food or water for a pet.

[0021] With reference to FIG. **2**A, on an opposite of the bottom **119**, relative to the interior space **122**, the dish **104** may include a ridge **125**. Turning to FIG. **2**B, the dish **104** includes a top opening **128**. In some implementations, a perimeter **131** of the top opening **128** may lie on an oblique plane **134** that intersects the central axis **116** at an angle **137** other than normal to (i.e., perpendicular to) the central axis **116**.

[0022] In some implementations, the dish **104** comprises a material that resists absorption of liquid (e.g., water, pet drool, moisture inherent in pet food). For example, the dish **104** may be made of a ceramic, or of another material with a waterproof interior coating.

[0023] As shown in FIG. **3**, the system **101** further includes a mat **110** having a top surface **140** and a bottom surface **143** that define a thickness **146**. As shown, the mat **110** includes a mat recess **149** that extends from the top surface **140** into the thickness **146**. In some implementations, the mat **110** comprises diatomaceous earth, which naturally absorbs water and other liquid, wicking it into the mat **110** and facilitating its evaporation from a larger surface area of the mat than that area through which the water or liquid was initially absorbed. In such implementations, mildew growth may be inhibited (by both the natural absorption and subsequent rapid evaporation of water and liquid and the inherent natural properties of diatomaceous earth); moreover, attraction of insects, rodents and other pests may be minimized, along with unpleasant odors that may otherwise be associated with persistent moisture.

[0024] The mat **110** may be configured to omit sharp edges or corners—or at least sharp edges or corners with which a pet may contact. For example, the top surface **140** may be shaped as a closed composite figure (e.g., a figure having only straight and curved lines) that is void of sharp angles. As another example, the shape may be generally rectangular, with rounded corners. An edge **152** along a perimeter **155** of the top surface **140** may be chamfered.

[0025] The system **101** may further include a pedestal **107** having a bottom end **158**, a top end **161** and a height **164**, as shown in FIG. **4**. The bottom end **158** may have a shape and size that corresponds to the mat recess **149**—such that the bottom end **158** can be disposed in the mat recess **149**; and when the bottom end **158** is so disposed in the mat recess **149**, the mat recess **149** and bottom end **158** cooperate to substantially resist translation of the pedestal **107** relative to the mat **110**.

[0026] As shown, the pedestal **107** further includes a pedestal recess **167** at the top end **161**. The pedestal recess **167** may have a shape and size that corresponds to the ridge **125**—such that the ridge **125** can be disposed into the pedestal recess **167**; and when the ridge **125** is disposed into the pedestal recess **167**, the pedestal recess **167** and the ridge **125** cooperate to substantially resist translation of the dish **104** relative to the pedestal **107**.

[0027] As used herein, “substantially resist” may mean resisting translation of more than a small percentage (e.g., 1%, 5%, 10%, 25%) of the dimensions of the mat recess **149** or pedestal recess **167** (e.g., a diameter, in the case of a circular recess) or bottom end **158** or ridge **125** (e.g., the diameter, in the case of a circular bottom end **158** or circular ridge **125**). “Resisting” may mean resisting relative to a force that is commensurate with a pet drinking water or eating from the dish. “Cooperate” may mean that the mat recess **149** (or pedestal recess **167**) is not only deep enough to resist translation of the bottom end **158** of the pedestal **107** (or ridge **125**) when subjected to forces of a pet drinking or eating from the dish, but also that the proportions of the height **164** and a lateral dimension of the pedestal **107** are such that a low center-of-gravity is maintained—to further prevent the dish and/or pedestal from being tipped over when a pet cats or drinks from the dish.

[0028] In some implementations, the pedestal **107** comprises a polymer with some flexibility and resilience to cushion contact between the pedestal **107** and the dish **104** or between the pedestal **107** and the mat **110**. For example, in some implementations, the polymer has a Shore A durometer value of about 50. As used herein, “about,” “approximately” or “substantially” may mean within 1%, or 5%, or 10%, or 20%, or 50%, or 100% of a nominal value. In some implementations, the polymer is silicone.

[0029] FIGS. **5-10** illustrate additional views of an exemplary implementation of a pet provisioning system. In particular, FIG. **5** illustrates a left view of one implementation; FIG. **6** illustrates a right view thereof; FIG. **7** illustrates a front view thereof; FIG. **8** illustrates a back view thereof; FIG. **9** illustrates a top view thereof; and FIG. **10** illustrates a bottom view thereof.

[0030] Several implementations have been described with reference to exemplary aspects, but it will be understood by those skilled in the art that various changes may be made and equivalents may be substituted for elements thereof without departing from the contemplated scope. For example, recesses and the corresponding ridge or bottom edge may have difference shapes or sizes, or different means of cooperating to limit translation. Dishes may have shapes other than cylinders. The top edge may have a different shape or be at a different angle relative to a central axis. Different materials may be employed, including polymers, rubbers, plastics, synthetic and real woods, ceramics, etc. Components of the system may be secured to each other (e.g., with adhesives, fasteners, integrated cooperating threads or other twist-lock mechanisms, magnets, etc.). Mats may take various shapes, including irregular compound shapes or polygons. Some systems may include two dishes (e.g., one for water, one for food), two pedestals and two recesses in the mat. Some systems may omit the pedestal for one or more dishes, such that a dish may be partially disposed directly in the mat.

[0031] Many other variations are possible, and modifications may be made to adapt a particular situation or material to the teachings provided herein without departing from the essential scope thereof. Therefore, it is intended that the scope include all aspects falling within the scope of the appended claims.

Claims

1. A pet provisioning system, comprising: a dish having a cylindrical wall, a central axis, a planar bottom perpendicular to the central axis, a top opening whose perimeter lies on an oblique plane that intersects the central axis at an angle other than normal to the central axis, and a ridge that extends below the planar bottom on an opposite side of an interior space defined by the planar bottom and the cylindrical wall; a mat having a top surface and a bottom surface, wherein the top surface and the bottom surface define a thickness, the mat comprising diatomaceous earth and further including a mat recess extending from the top surface into the thickness; a pedestal having a bottom end, a top end, a height, and a pedestal recess at the top end; wherein the bottom end has a shape and size that corresponds to the mat recess-such that the bottom end can be disposed into the mat recess; and when the bottom end is disposed in the mat recess, the mat recess and bottom end cooperate to substantially resist translation of the pedestal relative to the mat; and wherein the pedestal recess has a shape and size that corresponds to the ridge-such that the ridge can be disposed into the pedestal recess; and when the ridge is disposed in the pedestal recess, the pedestal recess and the ridge cooperate to substantially resist translation of the dish relative to the pedestal.

2. The pet provisioning system of claim 1, wherein the dish comprises a material that resists absorption of liquid.

3. The pet provisioning system of claim 2, wherein the material comprises ceramic.

4. The pet provisioning system of claim 1, wherein the pedestal comprises silicone having a Shore A durometer of about 50.

5. The pet provisioning system of claim 1, wherein the top surface of the mat is shaped as a closed composite figure that is void of sharp angles.

6. The pet provisioning system of claim 1, wherein the mat is generally rectangular in shape, with rounded corners and a chamfered edge along a perimeter of its top surface.